of central banking and regulation, and perhaps because some of my warnings were surprisingly seen as challenges to the government. Nevertheless, I saw these speeches as part of the Governor's responsibility as the primary technocrat managing macroeconomic risk for the country.

Being an academic, I wrote all my speeches myself. My wife, Radhika, suffered through early drafts of many speeches, offering constructive criticism. I then had the relevant subject matter expert at the RBI look at the speech to check for accuracy, followed by a read from my very able executive assistant (first, the ever-dependable Vivek Aggarwal who was succeeded by Vaibhav Chaturvedi). Finally, after Alpana Killawala, our Chief General Manager for Communications, took a pass screening for possible political controversy, I made final touches and delivered the speech.

Press attention was always intense, even in locales that the press were supposed to be excluded from – someone present would always be willing to speak to the press or post on social media. Much of the press attention was perhaps initially in the hope that I would offer tit-bits on the direction of future monetary policy, but as the press realized I did not speak on new policy outside monetary policy meetings, I like to believe that they came because the speeches were interesting. At any rate, press attention was a double-edged sword, as we will see. While it allowed me to get the RBI's messages out easily, a misunderstood speech or misinterpreted comment could make headlines and create unnecessary frictions. I saw this as an unavoidable cost of public engagement, but I did sometimes question whether the misinterpretation was accidental or deliberate.

The job of Governor is probably the most fulfilling job any Indian economist could aspire for. There were many days when I went home tired but happy that we had really made a difference. There are very